Jude

Key Notes, Cross-References, and Messianic Connections (WEB)

Twenty-five verses, written by a man who grew up in the same house as Yahshua.

He does not say so. He calls himself a servant of Jesus Christ, and brother of James.

He meant to write a happy letter about the salvation they shared. He could not.

Something had crept into the assembly, quietly, through the side door.

Men who took the grace of God and turned it into permission.

So he writes the other letter instead. Contend for the faith, once for all delivered.

Then a gallery of warnings from the whole of Scripture.

A people saved out of Egypt and still lost in the wilderness.

Angels who left the place they were given.

Sodom, going after strange flesh.

Michael the archangel, who would not even curse the devil, but said: the Lord rebuke you.

Cain. Balaam. Korah.

Hidden reefs at the love feasts. Clouds with no rain. Trees with no fruit, twice dead.

Wandering stars.

And then, after all of that, he turns to the faithful and speaks softly.

Keep yourselves in the love of God.

Have mercy on the doubting. Pull the others out of the fire.

And he ends with one of the most beautiful doxologies in the Bible.

Now to Him who is able to keep you from stumbling, and to present you faultless before the presence of His glory with great joy.

This is not just history.

This is a mirror.

And tonight, we let the Word fill us.

JUDE - Contend for the Faith, Wandering Stars, and Him Who Is Able to Keep You

Key Notes

- Jude is Judah, one of the brothers of Yahshua named in the Gospels. James, the brother he names, led the assembly in Jerusalem. Neither ever calls himself the Lord's brother. Both call themselves His servant (Jude 1:1, Mark 6:3).
- The brothers who did not believe in Him while He walked among them became His servants after He rose. Jude is living proof that unbelief at the family table is not the end of the story (Jude 1:1, John 7:5).
- "Called, sanctified by God the Father, and kept for Jesus Christ." Kept appears at the start and again at the end: kept for Him, keep yourselves in God's love, and Him who is able to keep you (Jude 1:1, 1:21, 1:24).
- He had planned a letter about our common salvation and was constrained to write this one instead. Sometimes the letter you want to write is not the letter that is needed (Jude 1:3).
- "Contend earnestly" is an athlete's or a wrestler's word, the effort of a contest. Not quarrel - contend (Jude 1:3).
- "The faith which was once for all delivered to the saints." Delivered once, and complete. Nothing new needs to be added to it, and nothing taken away (Jude 1:3, Deuteronomy 4:2).
- "Certain men who crept in secretly." They came in through the side door. False teachers rarely announce themselves at the front (Jude 1:4).
- "Turning the grace of our God into indecency." Grace treated as permission to live without restraint. Grace was never meant to set aside obedience; it is what makes obedience possible (Jude 1:4, Titus 2:11-12).
- "Denying our only Master, God, and Lord, Jesus Christ." Master here is despotes, the word for an owner. They did not deny His existence. They denied His authority over how they lived (Jude 1:4).
- "The Lord, having saved a people out of the land of Egypt." Some of the oldest manuscripts read Jesus here - Yahshua saved a people out of Egypt. The WEB reads the Lord. Either way, the one who brought Israel out is the one Jude serves (Jude 1:5, Exodus 20:2).
- A whole generation was saved out of Egypt and still died in the wilderness because they did not believe. Being delivered once does not make continuing in unbelief safe (Jude 1:5, Numbers 14:29-30).
- "Angels who didn't keep their first domain, but deserted their own dwelling place." Many, from the earliest Jewish and Christian readers on, connect this with the sons of God in Genesis 6 who took human wives, and Kingdom Life reads it that way (Jude 1:6, Genesis 6:2, 6:4).

- “Even as Sodom and Gomorrah… in the same way as these.” The comparison is to the angels just named. Both crossed a boundary God had set: the angels left their place, and Sodom went after strange flesh (Jude 1:6-7, Genesis 19:4-5).
- “Strange flesh” is literally other flesh, flesh of a different kind. The men of Sodom were demanding the angelic visitors in Lot’s house (Jude 1:7, Genesis 19:5).
- “In their dreaming” - they claim visions as their authority. Dreams are the source; the flesh is the result (Jude 1:8, Deuteronomy 13:1-3).
- Michael the archangel disputing with the devil over Moses’ body is not told in the Hebrew Scriptures, which say only that Yahweh buried Moses and no one knows where. Early writers say Jude drew it from a Jewish work called the Assumption of Moses (Jude 1:9, Deuteronomy 34:5-6).
- “May the Lord rebuke you” are the very words spoken to Satan in Zechariah 3, over Joshua the high priest. Even the archangel left the rebuke to Yahweh. If Michael would not speak abusively about the devil, no man has license to (Jude 1:9, Zechariah 3:2).
- Michael’s name means who is like El? It is a question, and the answer is no one - which is exactly why he would not presume (Jude 1:9).
- Three men, three ways to go wrong. Cain, who murdered his brother out of envy. Balaam, who sold his gift for hire and taught Israel to sin at Peor. Korah, who rose up against the authority Yahweh had set (Jude 1:11, Genesis 4:8, Numbers 31:16, 16:31-33).
- “Hidden rocky reefs in your love feasts.” The love feasts were the meals the believers shared. A reef is invisible from the surface until the ship is on it (Jude 1:12).
- “Shepherds who without fear feed themselves” is Ezekiel 34: woe to the shepherds of Israel who feed themselves instead of the sheep (Jude 1:12, Ezekiel 34:2).
- Clouds without water promise rain and deliver nothing. Proverbs says the same of a man who boasts of a gift he never gives (Jude 1:12, Proverbs 25:14).
- “Autumn trees without fruit, twice dead, plucked up by the roots.” Fruitless at the very season fruit is expected, dead, and uprooted (Jude 1:12, Matthew 7:19).
- “Wild waves of the sea, foaming out their own shame.” Isaiah: the wicked are like the troubled sea that cannot rest, casting up mire and mud (Jude 1:13, Isaiah 57:20).
- “Wandering stars” - lights that do not hold their course and so cannot guide anyone home (Jude 1:13).
- Enoch, the seventh from Adam, is quoted here. The words match the opening of the book of Enoch, an ancient Jewish writing. Jude quotes it the way Paul quotes Greek poets: a true word, from a source not otherwise counted as Scripture. Jude does not call the whole book Scripture (Jude 1:14-15).
- “Behold, the Lord came with ten thousands of his holy ones.” Moses said Yahweh came from Sinai with ten thousands of holy ones, and Zechariah: Yahweh my God will come, and all the holy ones with you (Jude 1:14, Deuteronomy 33:2, Zechariah 14:5).

- Ungodly, in one form or another, appears four times in one verse. Jude is not being subtle (Jude 1:15).
- “Murmurers and complainers” - the wilderness word again, the sin of the generation that came out of Egypt (Jude 1:16, Numbers 14:27).
- “Their mouth speaks proud things.” Pride again, in the mouth (Jude 1:16).
- “Remember the words which have been spoken before by the apostles.” The answer to new teaching is old teaching, remembered (Jude 1:17, 2 Peter 3:3).
- “Sensual, not having the Spirit.” For all their claims of dreams and visions, they lack the one thing that matters (Jude 1:19).
- Four instructions for the faithful: build yourselves up on the faith, pray in the Holy Spirit, keep yourselves in God’s love, and look for the mercy of the Lord (Jude 1:20-21).
- “Keep yourselves in God’s love.” Not make God love you - keep yourselves where His love is (Jude 1:21, John 15:9-10).
- Three kinds of people to help: those who doubt, to whom you show mercy; those already in the fire, whom you snatch out; and those you help with fear, hating even the garment stained by the flesh (Jude 1:22-23).
- “Snatching them out of the fire” is Zechariah 3 again: is this not a burning stick plucked out of the fire? And there Joshua’s filthy garments were taken off him and he was clothed in rich clothing (Jude 1:23, Zechariah 3:2-4).
- “Him who is able to keep them from stumbling.” After a whole letter of people who fell, the last word is the One who keeps (Jude 1:24, Psalm 121:3).
- “To present you faultless before the presence of his glory in great joy.” Faultless is the word used of a sacrifice without blemish. He presents us that way, and He does it with joy (Jude 1:24).
- “To God our Savior, who alone is wise.” Isaiah: there is no other God besides me, a just God and a Savior (Jude 1:25, Isaiah 45:21).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
Do Not Add or Take Away	Jude 1:3 • Deuteronomy 4:2 • Proverbs 30:5-6
Saved, Then Fallen in the Wilderness	Jude 1:5 • Numbers 14:29-30 • 1 Corinthians 10:5
Angels Who Left Their Place	Jude 1:6 • Genesis 6:2 • Genesis 6:4
Sodom and Strange Flesh	Jude 1:7 • Genesis 19:4-5 • Genesis 19:24
Yahweh Rebuke You	Jude 1:9 • Zechariah 3:2 • Deuteronomy 34:5-6
Cain, Balaam and Korah	Jude 1:11 • Genesis 4:5-8 • Numbers 31:16 • Numbers 16:31-33
Clouds and Wind Without Rain	Jude 1:12 • Proverbs 25:14 • Ezekiel 34:2

Topic	References
The Troubled Sea	Jude 1:13 • Isaiah 57:20

Messianic Connections

Connection	References
Yahweh Who Brought You Out of Egypt	Jude 1:5 • Exodus 20:2 • Hosea 13:4
Coming With Ten Thousands of Holy Ones	Jude 1:14 • Deuteronomy 33:2 • Zechariah 14:5
Judgment by Fire on All Flesh	Jude 1:15 • Isaiah 66:15-16
A Burning Stick Plucked From the Fire	Jude 1:23 • Zechariah 3:2 • Amos 4:11
Filthy Garments Taken Away	Jude 1:23 • Zechariah 3:3-4 • Isaiah 64:6
He Will Not Let Your Foot Be Moved	Jude 1:24 • Psalm 121:3 • Psalm 37:24
A Just God and a Savior	Jude 1:25 • Isaiah 45:21 • Isaiah 43:11

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - Jude Commentary (David Guzik) - verse by verse through Jude's warning and his doxology
- BibleProject - Jude Overview - a short video on how Jude uses the Hebrew Scriptures and Jewish literature

Jude 1 - Opening Intro

Jude is one of the shortest books in the Bible. Twenty-five verses. And it was written by somebody who grew up in the same house as Yahshua.

Jude is Judah. Mark 6 lists the brothers of Jesus - James, Joses, Judah and Simon. This is that Judah.

And remember, in John 7, His brothers did not believe in Him. They mocked Him. And now here is one of those brothers, writing a letter, and the first thing he calls himself is a servant of Jesus Christ.

Not His brother. His servant. He had every right to say I grew up with Him. He did not.

And he says: I really wanted to write to you about the salvation we share. That was the letter I had planned. But I had to write this one instead. Contend for the faith that was delivered to the saints once for all.

Because something had happened. Certain men had crept in secretly. Through the side door. And they were turning the grace of God into a license to live however they wanted.

That is still the most common way to wreck a congregation. Not by attacking grace. By twisting it. Grace means I can do what I want. Grace means the instructions do not matter anymore.

And Jude says: let me remind you of some things you already know.

The Lord saved a whole people out of Egypt - and then destroyed the ones who did not believe. And some of the oldest manuscripts actually say Jesus there. Yahshua brought them out of Egypt.

Then the angels who did not keep their place, who left their own dwelling. That goes back to Genesis 6 - the sons of God who took the daughters of men. He has them chained in darkness for the judgment.

Then Sodom and Gomorrah, which in the same way went after strange flesh. Other flesh. They crossed the line God drew, just like the angels did.

And then my favorite detail in the whole letter. Michael the archangel, arguing with the devil over the body of Moses, would not even bring a harsh accusation against him. He just said: the Lord rebuke you.

If the archangel would not mouth off to the devil, what business do we have mouthing off about anybody?

And Michael's name is a question. Who is like El? And the answer is: nobody. That is why he did not presume.

Then Jude names three men. Cain - who killed his brother out of envy. Balaam - who sold his gift for money. Korah - who rebelled against the authority God set up, and the ground opened and swallowed him.

And then he describes these false teachers with a string of pictures you do not forget. Hidden reefs at your love feasts - you do not see them until your ship is torn open. Clouds without water - all promise, no rain. Trees in harvest season with no fruit. Twice dead. Pulled up by the roots. Wild waves foaming up their own shame. Wandering stars that cannot guide anybody home.

And then he quotes Enoch, the seventh from Adam. Behold, the Lord comes with ten thousands of His holy ones to execute judgment.

And then - after all of that - he turns to the faithful, and his whole tone changes.

But you, beloved. Build yourselves up on your most holy faith. Pray in the Holy Spirit. Keep yourselves in the love of God.

And then: on some have mercy - the ones who are doubting. Others, pull them out of the fire. That is Zechariah 3, where Joshua the high priest stands there in filthy clothes, and God says: is this not a burning stick pulled out of the fire? Take off his filthy garments.

And Jude closes with the most beautiful benediction in the New Testament. Now to Him who is able to keep you from stumbling, and to present you faultless before the presence of His glory with great joy - to God our Savior, who alone is wise, be glory and majesty, dominion and power, both now and forever.

Before we read - notice that a letter full of people who fell ends with the One who keeps you from falling. The last word is not the warning. It is Him.

Jude 1:1-25 (WEB)

1 Jude, a servant of Jesus Christ, and brother of James, to those who are called, sanctified by God the Father, and kept for Jesus Christ:

2 Mercy to you and peace and love be multiplied.

3 Beloved, while I was very eager to write to you about our common salvation, I was constrained to write to you exhorting you to contend earnestly for the faith which was once for all delivered to the saints.[1]

4 For there are certain men who crept in secretly, even those who were long ago written about for this condemnation: ungodly men, turning the grace of our God into indecency, and denying our only Master, God, and Lord, Jesus Christ.

5 Now I desire to remind you, though you already know this, that the Lord, having saved a people out of the land of Egypt, afterward destroyed those who didn't believe.[2,3]

6 Angels who didn't keep their first domain, but deserted their own dwelling place, he has kept in everlasting bonds under darkness for the judgment of the great day.[4]

7 Even as Sodom and Gomorrah, and the cities around them, having, in the same way as these, given themselves over to sexual immorality and gone after strange flesh, are shown as an example, suffering the punishment of eternal fire.[5]

8 Yet in the same way, these also in their dreaming defile the flesh, despise authority, and slander celestial beings.

9 But Michael, the archangel, when contending with the devil and arguing about the body of Moses, dared not bring against him an abusive condemnation, but said, "May the Lord rebuke you!"[6]

10 But these speak evil of whatever things they don't know. They are destroyed in these things that they understand naturally, like the creatures without reason.

---

[1] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 4:2 • Proverbs 30:5-6 - *you shall not add to the word nor take from it, and do not add to his words, lest he reprove you*

[2] **Messianic Connection:** Exodus 20:2 • Hosea 13:4 - *I am Yahweh your God who brought you out of Egypt, and besides me there is no savior*

[3] **Cross-Reference:** Numbers 14:29-30 • 1 Corinthians 10:5 - *your dead bodies shall fall in this wilderness, and most of them were overthrown in the wilderness*

[4] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 6:2 • Genesis 6:4 - *the sons of God taking the daughters of men as wives, and the Nephilim in the earth in those days*

[5] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 19:4-5 • Genesis 19:24 - *the men of Sodom surrounding Lot's house for the visitors, and sulfur and fire rained from Yahweh*

[6] **Cross-Reference:** Zechariah 3:2 • Deuteronomy 34:5-6 - *Yahweh rebuke you, Satan, and Moses buried in Moab with no man knowing his tomb*

11 Woe to them! For they went in the way of Cain, and ran riotously in the error of Balaam for hire, and perished in Korah's rebellion.[7]

12 These are hidden rocky reefs in your love feasts when they feast with you, shepherds who without fear feed themselves; clouds without water, carried along by winds; autumn trees without fruit, twice dead, plucked up by the roots;[8]

13 wild waves of the sea, foaming out their own shame; wandering stars, for whom the blackness of darkness has been reserved forever.[9]

14 About these also Enoch, the seventh from Adam, prophesied, saying, "Behold, the Lord came with ten thousands of his holy ones,[10]

15 to execute judgment on all, and to convict all the ungodly of all their works of ungodliness which they have done in an ungodly way, and of all the hard things which ungodly sinners have spoken against him."[11]

16 These are murmurers and complainers, walking after their lusts (and their mouth speaks proud things), showing respect of persons to gain advantage.

17 But you, beloved, remember the words which have been spoken before by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ.

18 They said to you that "In the last time there will be mockers, walking after their own ungodly lusts."

19 These are they who cause divisions, and are sensual, not having the Spirit.

20 But you, beloved, keep building up yourselves on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Spirit.

21 Keep yourselves in God's love, looking for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ to eternal life.

22 On some have compassion, making a distinction,

23 and some save, snatching them out of the fire with fear, hating even the clothing stained by the flesh.[12,13]

---

[7] **Cross-Reference:** Genesis 4:5-8 • Numbers 31:16 • Numbers 16:31-33 - *Cain rising up against Abel, the counsel of Balaam at Peor, and the earth swallowing Korah's men*

[8] **Cross-Reference:** Proverbs 25:14 • Ezekiel 34:2 - *clouds and wind without rain, and woe to the shepherds who feed themselves*

[9] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 57:20 - *the wicked are like the troubled sea, casting up mire and mud*

[10] **Messianic Connection:** Deuteronomy 33:2 • Zechariah 14:5 - *Yahweh came from the ten thousands of holy ones, and Yahweh my God will come, and all the holy ones with you*

[11] **Messianic Connection:** Isaiah 66:15-16 - *Yahweh will come with fire and execute judgment on all flesh*

[12] **Messianic Connection:** Zechariah 3:2 • Amos 4:11 - *a burning stick plucked out of the fire*

[13] **Messianic Connection:** Zechariah 3:3-4 • Isaiah 64:6 - *the filthy garments taken off and rich clothing put on, and our righteousness like a polluted garment*

24 Now to him who is able to keep them from stumbling, and to present you faultless before the presence of his glory in great joy,[14]

25 to God our Savior, who alone is wise, be glory and majesty, dominion and power, both now and forever. Amen.[15]

---

[14] **Messianic Connection:** Psalm 121:3 • Psalm 37:24 - *he will not allow your foot to be moved, and though he stumble he shall not fall*

[15] **Messianic Connection:** Isaiah 45:21 • Isaiah 43:11 - *a just God and a Savior, there is no one besides me, and besides me there is no savior*

Major Themes in Jude

- A brother of Yahshua who called himself His servant
- Unbelief at the family table that turned into service
- The letter he wanted to write, and the letter that was needed
- Contending for a faith delivered once for all
- Men who came in by the side door
- Grace twisted into permission
- Denying His authority while keeping His name
- Saved out of Egypt and lost in the wilderness
- Angels who left their place, and a city that went after strange flesh
- An archangel who left the rebuke to Yahweh
- Cain’s envy, Balaam’s price, Korah’s rebellion
- Hidden reefs, rainless clouds, fruitless trees, wandering stars
- The Lord coming with ten thousands of His holy ones
- Murmuring, the old wilderness sin
- New teaching answered by old words remembered
- Build, pray, keep, look
- Mercy for the doubting and rescue for those in the fire
- Garments stained by the flesh, and garments exchanged
- Him who is able to keep you from stumbling
- Presented faultless, with great joy

Benediction

Let this be the word that goes before us tonight:

May we be called, set apart, and kept for Yahshua.

May mercy, peace and love be multiplied to us.

May we contend for the faith without becoming contentious.

May we guard the side door of our hearts and our assemblies.

May we never turn grace into permission.

May we finish the journey we began when He brought us out.

May we stay in the place He has given us.

May we leave every rebuke to Him.

May we refuse the way of Cain, the price of Balaam and the pride of Korah.

May we be clouds that bring rain and trees that bear fruit.

May we hold our course and help others home.

May we remember the words spoken before us.

May we build ourselves up on our most holy faith.

May we pray in the Holy Spirit.

May we keep ourselves in the love of God.

May we show mercy to those who doubt.

May we pull others out of the fire.

May He keep us from stumbling.

May He present us faultless before His glory with great joy.

May every promise He has spoken over us stand up, come forth, and manifest in its appointed time.

Amen.